SWRS Southwest Recovery Services

Providing Creative Solutions to Common Problems



CREATIVE-SERVICES RECEIVABLES RECOVERY · CAPABILITIES OVERVIEW

Debt Collection for Creative & Media Studios

Recovering unpaid project invoices, deposits & retainers — on pure contingency

Prepared for **Emerald Fox** · July 2026

01 — INTRODUCTION

A recovery partner for the money you've already earned

To Charissa and the Emerald Fox team — thank you for reaching out. Emerald Fox carries the same hard-to-collect balances every operation does: unpaid project invoices, balances left after a deposit, final-delivery balances, and retainer arrears. Chasing them takes time your team doesn't have — and the longer they sit, the harder they are to collect.

Past-due balances aren't a paperwork problem — they're a cash-flow problem. They quietly age into write-offs while you focus on the work in front of you.

Southwest Recovery Services works these receivables on **pure contingency since 2004** — licensed and bonded where required. Recovery is **reputation-first** and fully compliant, with skip tracing to locate a customer who's gone quiet. You place accounts through a secure portal in minutes. No recovery, no fee.

02 — AT A GLANCE

Two decades of receivables recovery — nationwide

A documented, compliant recovery process you can hand off completely — no software to buy, no collection calls to make, no risk to the name you've built.

2004 Recovering commercial receivables since	**$1.0B+** Receivables placed (all industries)	**$79M+** Recovered for clients	**880K+** Accounts worked
51% of matured client portfolios see a recovery	**50** states — nationwide recovery reach	**4.9★** Google client rating	**$0** upfront — no recovery, no fee

Commercial & B2B collections since 2004 · Nationwide — all 50 states · 12 offices across 7 states · Skip tracing on businesses & principals · Contingency — no recovery, no fee

RECOGNIZED & FEATURED BY

USA TODAY · Financial Services Review · FSR • Top 10 List 2025 Recognition · International Business Times · CFO Tech Outlook · insideARM · insideARM — The DSO Blind Spot (2026)

ACCREDITED & RECOGNIZED

Better Business Bureau · ACA International · Top Collections Company Clutch United States 2026 · Chamber of Commerce.com A+ Rated · ★ 4.9 · 38 Google reviews

Memberships: **ACA International** · TAA · AAGD · NARPM

03 — YOUR QUESTIONS, ANSWERED

The questions owners ask — answered directly

Exactly how we work, in plain terms, before a single account is placed.

YOUR QUESTION	SOUTHWEST RECOVERY SERVICES
1. Fee structure	Pure contingency — $0 upfront, no retainer, no monthly minimum. You pay a pre-agreed percentage only of what we actually recover. If we don't collect, you owe nothing.
2. Will this hurt our reputation?	This matters most for a business built on referrals and reviews, and it's how we're built. Recovery is professional and fully compliant — no threats, no misrepresentation. We represent Emerald Fox the way you would.
3. What can we place?	Unpaid invoices, past-due customer accounts, and broken payment arrangements — business (B2B) accounts and, where applicable, consumer balances.
4. What about an account that's gone quiet?	Skip tracing to locate the responsible party — a business and its principals, or an individual who moved — then persistent, documented contact. Reaching a non-responsive account is where an outside agency outperforms doing it yourself.
5. Compliance & onboarding	FDCPA, Reg F and TCPA guardrails on every account. Onboarding is low-lift — export an aging / balance report (or a simple spreadsheet) and upload it through our secure portal. Outreach begins within 24–48 hours.

THE SWRS CLIENT PORTAL

Simple hand-off and full visibility, on demand

Every account you place is managed through our secure portal — built so a busy team can hand off a balance in minutes and check on it any time.

PLACEMENT IN MINUTES

Upload a simple spreadsheet or account record — customer, balance, contact and invoice. We map your columns; no re-keying.

SECURE DOCUMENT EXCHANGE

Send invoices, agreements and account records safely inside the portal — the paperwork that settles a dispute fast.

REAL-TIME STATUS

Check what's been recovered and what's still in progress on demand — no phone tag.

DIRECT-PAYMENT REPORTING

If a customer pays you directly after placement, log it in a click so we stop contacting them and your books stay right.

► Portal Video Tour

04 — CASE STUDIES

SWRS Recovery Case Studies

Actual placed-versus-recovered results from Southwest Recovery's **commercial and consumer book**, anonymized by sub-sector, individual client names withheld. Real recovered dollars on placed accounts.

TRADES & CONTRACTING

Contractor A/R

$20K recovered

of ~$20K placed

100% recovered

RESTORATION & FIELD SERVICES

Service-invoice A/R

$44K recovered

of ~$48K placed

92% recovered

PROFESSIONAL-SERVICES FIRM

Client-fee A/R

$212K recovered

of ~$273K placed

78% recovered

COMMERCIAL FACILITY SERVICES

B2B net-terms accounts

$103K recovered

of ~$166K placed

62% recovered

MECHANICAL / PLUMBING CONTRACTOR

Installed-work A/R

$70K recovered

of ~$151K placed

47% recovered

GENERAL B2B SERVICES

Trade-account A/R

$25K recovered

of ~$61K placed

40% recovered

Anonymized by sector from Southwest Recovery's book; individual client names withheld. Results vary by account age, balance, documentation quality and industry. We do not publish blended portfolio averages.

THE COST OF WAITING

Why balances recover best while they're fresh

A balance is most collectible while it's fresh — the work or sale is recent, contact details are current, and the customer remembers what they owe. Every month it ages, people move, numbers change, and the balance competes with newer bills. The highest-leverage move isn't chasing harder — it's handing it off sooner.

THE AGE CURVE

Fresh balances (under ~90–120 days past due) resolve at materially higher rates; balances left a year or more collect a fraction of that.

THE STANDING RULE

A simple "place at 90 days" habit recovers more than letting balances drift toward write-off — and on contingency there's no cost to placing.

Real placed-versus-recovered results from SWRS's commercial and consumer book, anonymized by sub-sector; individual client names withheld. Results vary by account age, balance size and documentation; we give an honest, age-based read on a representative sample first.

05 — BUILT FOR EMERALD FOX

We understand your ledger

Whatever you do, unpaid accounts share the same profile. Our playbook is built to recover them without adding to your workload.

Unpaid invoices & balances

The work got done or the goods/service delivered and the customer never paid — pursued professionally so you don't have to make the awkward call.

Skip tracing & persistence

We locate customers who've gone quiet and pursue with documented, compliant demand.

B2B & consumer coverage

Business accounts worked as B2B; consumer accounts under FDCPA / Reg F.

Reputation-first & contingency

Professional contact that protects your name — and pure contingency, so recovery costs nothing unless we collect.

06 — AI-POWERED COLLECTIONS

Recovery run on an AI-driven platform — Aktos

Every account SWRS works runs on Aktos, a next-generation, AI-driven collections platform — with compliance built into the workflow, not bolted on afterward. It's how a boutique, people-first agency delivers enterprise-grade speed, consistency, and auditability.

AI workflow automation

Repetitive steps are automated and every account is scored and routed by predicted payment likelihood — so the right strategy reaches the right account first, without manual queue-picking.

Omnichannel outreach

Coordinated email, SMS, and voice, timed to when a debtor is most likely to engage — replacing high-friction call blasts with respectful, data-driven contact.

Compliance built in

FDCPA, Reg F, and TCPA guardrails are enforced inside the automation, with phone-number and consent checks before outreach — documented and defensible on every account.

Real-time dashboards

You see status, segmentation, and recovery performance on your portfolio in real time — full transparency, not a monthly PDF.

API-first intake

Secure SFTP/API placement means accounts start working without data lag — roughly 50% faster acknowledgment and validation of new placements.

Data-driven scoring

Dynamic scoring and segmentation predict payment likelihood and concentrate effort where recovery is most achievable — earlier intervention that trims DSO and reduces disputes.

The result is the combination clients rarely get from a legacy agency: faster cash and cleaner compliance at the same time. Automation accelerates recovery and standardizes documentation, while empathy-first, data-driven contact protects your brand and keeps disputes and complaints low.

07 — MEET THE FOUNDER

Built by a collector with 30 years on the phones — not a CEO with zero collection experience



Steven Dietz

Founder & Chief Executive Officer

Featured in USA Today, International Business Times & Financial Services Review — Top AR Management Service, 2025 · ACA International member.

Steven Dietz didn't come to collections from the corner office — he came from the phones. He started as a collector and credit analyst before he was 20, was tapped by Aaron's to train collectors across 100+ locations, and has spent nearly 30 years in receivables. Along the way he became convinced the industry's bad reputation was a choice, not a requirement: businesses get paid faster when recovery is built on listening and respect rather than aggressive calls and empty threats.

He founded Southwest Recovery Services in 2004 on that principle — a national, family-owned receivables partner that treats every debtor as a person and every client relationship as worth protecting. Two decades later he still coaches the teams and works accounts personally — an operator who has actually done the job, not a manager who has only overseen it.

> "Regardless of the means of recovery, our focus is always on preserving goodwill and representing the client professionally.
>
> **— Steven Dietz, Founder & Chief Executive Officer, Southwest Recovery Services**

08 — RESOURCES

Take it with you

Download this overview and the supporting white papers to share with your team.

This capabilities overview

PDF · prepared for Emerald Fox

Download PDF ↓

The Cost of Waiting: Receivables & Recovery

Why aging kills recovery · PDF

Download PDF ↓

The Placement-File Standard

Maximizing recovery · PDF

Download PDF ↓

The Aktos Advantage

Our AI-driven collections platform · PDF

Download PDF ↓

The Experian Intelligence Advantage

Data & skip-tracing stack · PDF

Download PDF ↓

The Recovery Waterfall

Full recovery lifecycle · PDF

Download PDF ↓

09 — NEXT STEP

Let’s turn your past-due accounts back into cash.

A quick call to walk the balances you’ve written off, answer your questions, and put a contingency rate against a representative sample — no cost, no obligation.

Book a 30-minute discovery call →

Brenn Morrow
Business Development Manager

bmorrow@swrecovery.com
(432) 253-0503 · (817) 945-8322
swrecovery.com

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